

RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 4, 2026

Trending now — 6 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	Rising costs just overtook everything else as liquor retailers' #1 worry for 2026 (66% name it their top concern), while the non-alcoholic category has stalled — 81% of liquor stores already carry NA products, but fewer than half plan to expand the shelf space.	BottlePOS — Liquor Retail Report 2026	LinkedIn post, owner-to-owner. “Rising costs” is too vague to act on — the actual fix is seeing margin by SKU, not just by category. A short post making the case for per-SKU cost/margin visibility (not just “sales by category”) as the real answer to “costs are up,” using the 66%/81% stats as the hook. No pricing claims — purely a “here’s what to actually look at” framing.

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2	The FDA just said it won't enforce certain FD&C Act provisions against hemp-derived oral CBD products marketed as dietary supplements — a real, fresh regulatory shift landing directly on CBD retailers' shelves this month.	Barron's via iTiger — Cannabis Stocks on Track for Best Week of 2026 as FDA Loosens CBD Enforcement	Instagram/LinkedIn carousel for CBD retailers. A plain, factual 3-slide carousel: (1) what changed, (2) what it means for a dietary-supplement-labeled CBD product on your shelf, (3) “this doesn't change your state's rules — check those separately.” Purely compliance-education, no health claims, no “stock up” framing — reinforces RetailzPOS's category-specific compliance credibility with CBD owners without touching pricing or dosage.
3	The ongoing shutdown is starting to pull discretionary spending down for furloughed and unpaid federal workers — the last comparable shutdown saw affected households cut spending fast and lean on credit, with ripple effects landing on the local businesses (food, convenience goods) those households spend at.	EveryCRSReport — The 2025 (FY2026) Government Shutdown: Economic Effects	Instagram/Facebook post, value-forward not discount-forward. Not a sale, not a price claim — a “we see you” post for stores near federal offices/bases: highlight small-basket, everyday-value SKUs and point out loyalty perks that reward frequent small trips (Moolah Points stacking on repeat visits) rather than big-basket spend. Tone: practical solidarity, not opportunism.

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4	TikTok's "Oops, wrong way" trend — POV clips built around suspense and a hidden-clue payoff, inviting rewatches to spot what was foreshadowed.	Virlo — What's Trending on TikTok	TikTok, format-jack for convenience/ smoke-vape stores. POV: customer confidently heads toward an open shelf for an age-restricted item (vape, certain CBD products) — "wrong way" reveal is the counter, where it's actually kept for ID-check compliance. Played for a laugh, not a lecture; caption: "the age-restricted aisle is wherever the ID scanner is 😊" Light, not preachy.
5	TikTok's "Perfect Pitch Challenge" — users test whether they can match a musical note, with self-deprecating captions about missing it.	Virlo — What's Trending on TikTok	TikTok, staff-culture video. In-store "perfect pitch" spin-off: staff try to guess the product purely from the POS scanner's beep (they all sound nearly identical, so it's genuinely funny), losing badly, captioned "perfect pitch challenge: retail edition." Pure behind-the-counter culture content, no pitch, no CTA needed — just reach and warmth.

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6	Retail-worker-respect content is having another moment — a Home Depot employee's TikTok about customers leaving messes drew 85K views and 1,200+ comments, and a Walmart checkout video around repeated bagging requests racked up 800K+ views, both reigniting the “be kind to the person at the register” conversation.	Daily Dot — Home Depot customer left mess, TVOverMind — Entitled Customer Is Put In Place By A Cashier	LinkedIn, founder-voice. Not a comment on any specific viral clip — a short, genuine post on how checkout friction itself breeds short tempers: slow ID checks, confusing bagging/payment steps, and long lines wear everyone down, staff included. Make the case that a faster, simpler checkout isn't just a sales metric, it's a kindness one. Ties naturally to RetailzPOS's single-motion tap-and-verify flow without naming it as the headline.

Skipped, no genuine angle: UK vape excise-tax and age-of-sale news (not a US regulatory concern and would misrepresent RetailzPOS's market if posted as relevant), and “In da klurb, we all fam” TikTok sound — covers the same “regulars are family” ground as yesterday's Suspect-trend loyalty idea, so repeating it today would be padding, not a new idea.

Compliance check: none of the above imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #1 and #2 are pure cost/compliance education, #3 is value-forward without a discount claim, #4-6 are light, non-promotional format and culture content.